52. Which of the following is not included in the assets of a commercial bank in India?
(a) Advances
(b) Deposits
(c) Investments
(d) Money at call and short notice

Ans : (b) A bank places its funds in assets to earn profits. The assets include investments, loans and advances, money at call purchased. It also includes the cash in hand with the banks and also the cash held with the RBI. The liabilities include deposits (both time and demands) and borrowings. So, the correct answer is option (b)

53. In the context of India, which of the following factors is/are contributor
1. The foreign currency earnings of India's IT sector
2. Increasing the government expenditure
3. Remittances from Indians abroad
Select the correct answer using the code given below.
(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (b) To reduce the risk of currency crisis, factors like remittance of foreign exchange earnings by citizens living abroad are helpful. In the context of India, the risk of a currency crisis can be reduced by the acquisition of foreign exchange by the IT sector, money sent by foreign Indians. The Policy of austerity measures helps to reduce the risk of the currency crisis and not the excess of government expenditure.

54. The Chairmen of public sector banks are selected by the
(a) Banks Board Bureau
(b) Reserve Bank of India
(c) Union Ministry of Finance
(d) Management of concerned bank

Ans : (a) The presidents of public sector banks are selected by the Bank Boards Bureau (BBB). The BBB has been formed as an autonomous advisory body with effect from 1 April, 2016. Its main function is to take administrative decisions related to public banks and appointment of heads of the bank.

55. The economic cost of food grains to the Food Corporation of India is Minimum Support Price and bonus (if any) paid to the farmers plus
(a) transportation cost only
(b) interest cost only
(c) procurement incidentals and distribution cost
(d) procurement incidentals and charges for godowns

Ans : (c) The economic cost of food grains for food corporations of India includes the relevant procurement charges and distribution cost along with the MSP and bonus. In order to encourage agricultural production, the government announces a minimum support price for 23 important agricultural produce. MSP has been considered as the base price.
Economic cost = MSP + Ancillary Expenses related to purchases (bonus) + Relevant procurement charges and distribution costs.

• Foreign Trade & Economic Organizations of India, Stock Market /Regulatory Board

56. Among the agricultural commodities imported by India, which one to the following accounts for the highest imports in terms of value in the last five years?
(a) Spices (b) Fresh fruits
(c) Pulses (d) Vegetable oils

Ans : (d) India has the highest proportion of edible oil among agriculturally imported commodities, which makes up about two-thirds of agricultural imports. India is a self-sufficient and apex producer in spices, fresh fruits and pulses production. The above mentioned agricultural commodities are also exported by India.
Vegetable oil has been imported maximum as the basis of price in the last 5 years; its details are as follows-

Year	Price (in USD)
2016-17	10892
2017-18	11637
2018-19	9890

57. Which of the Following is issued by registered foreign portfolio investors to overseas Investors who want to be a part of Indian Stock Market without registering themselves directly?
(a) Certificate of Deposit
(b) Commercial paper
(c) Promissory Note
(d) Participatory Note

Ans : (d) Participatory notes, also referred to as P-Notes or PNs, are financial instruments required by investors or hedge funds to invest in Indian securities without having to register with the securities and exchange board of India (SEBI). Investing through P-Notes is very simple. Hence, this method is very popular among foreign institutional investors. It was started in 1992.

58. Consider the following statements :
1. Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB) is the first regulatory body set up by the Government of India
2. One of the tasks of PNGRB is to ensure competitive markets for gas.
3. Appeals against the decisions of PNGRB go before the Appellate Tribunals for Electricity.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (b) The Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board (PNGRB) is not the first regulatory body set up by the government of India, before which a number of regulatory bodies have been formed. PNGRB has been formed in the year 2006 under the Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board Act, 2006. Whereas earlier Khadi and Village Industries Commission was established in 1956, SEBI in 1992, TRAI in 1997 and IRDA in 1999. One of the key function markets for gas appeals against the decisions of PNGRB is made before the Appellate Tribunals for Electricity.

59. With reference to Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB), consider the following statements :
1. AIIB has more than 80 member nations.
2. India is the largest shareholder in AIIB.
3. AIIB does not have any members from outside Asia.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (a) The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) is a multilateral development bank established on 16 January, 2016, headquartered in Beijing. It currently has 102 members. The authorized capital of this bank is 100 billion dollars. The maximum shareholding is that of China, India and Russia respectively. Members of this bank are also countries outside of Asia, such as Canada, Egypt, United Kingdom, France, Germany etc. Hence, statements 2 and 3 are wrong, so the correct answer is option (a).

SCIENCE

• Physics

60. In the context of digital technologies for entertainment, consider the following statements.
(1) In Augmented Reality (AR), a simulated environment is created and the physical world is completely shut out.
(2) In Virtual Reality (VR), images generated from a computer are projected onto real-life objects or surroundings.
(3) AR allows individuals to be present in the world and improves the experience using the camera of smart-phone or PC.
(4) VR closes the world, and transposes an individual, providing complete immersion experience.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 and 4
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 4 only

Ans : (b) Virtual Reality (VR) is an artificial, computer- generated simulation or recreation of a real-life environment or situation. It immerses the user by making them feel like they are experiencing the stimulating reality first-head, primarily by stimulating their vision and hearing. Hence, statement 2 is not correct but 4 is correct.
Augmented Reality (AR) is a technology that layers computer-generated enhancements atop an existing reality in order to make it more meaningful through the ability to interact with it. AR is developed into apps and used on mobile devices to blend digital components into the real world in such a way that they enhance one another but can also be told apart easily. Hence, statement 1 is not correct but 3 is correct.

61. Recently, scientists observed the merger of giant 'blackholes' billions of light-years away from the Earth. What is the significance of this observation?
(a) 'Higgs boson particles' were detected.
(b) 'Gravitational waves' were detected.
(c) Possibility of inter-galactic space travel through 'wormhole' was confirmed.
(d) It enabled the scientists to understand 'singularity'.

Ans : (b) Scientists expressed the possibility of a collision of a possible black hole neutron star in the laser. Interferometer Gravitational- wave observatory and Virgo Interferometer on 26th April, 2019. the incident was detected with the help of the LIGO and European Gravity observatory located in the United States. Thus the observation of the merger of giant blackholes billion of light-years away was a Unique phenomenon. The significance of this observation is that it detected Gravitational waves.

• Chemistry

62. Which of the following statements are correct about the deposits of 'methane hydrate'?
1. Global warming might trigger the release of methane gas from these deposits.
2. Large deposits of 'methane hydrate' are found in Arctic Tundra and under the seafloor.
3. Methane in atmosphere oxidizes to carbon dioxide after a decade or two.
Select the correct answer using the code given below.
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (d) Methane hydrates can only form under very specific physical, chemical and geological conditions. High water pressures and low temperatures provide the best conditions. Methane Hydrate deposits may be several hundred meters thick and generally occur in two types of settings. Under Arctic permafrost and beneath the ocean floor.
Global warming led to the increase in the temperature which consequently destabilize the methane hydrates and thus release of methane. Methane is relatively short-lived in the atmosphere; a molecule carbon dioxide within a decade or so, mainly by reaction with another trace gas, the hydroxyl radical (OH).

63. In India, the use of Carbofuran, Methyl Parathion, Phorate and Triazophos is viewed with apprehension. These chemicals are used as
(a) pesticides in agriculture
(b) preservatives in processed foods
(c) fruit-ripening agents
(d) moisturizing agents in cosmetics

Ans : (a) Chemicals such as phonsphamidon, lindane, fluoropyriphos, heptachlor, malathion, carbofuran, methyl parathion, phorates and triazophos are known as pesticides in agriculture.